

AHMET ERGURUM

Milwaukee, Wisconsin, USA | aergurum@uwm.edu | [in LinkedIn](#) | [Website](#) | [Google Scholar](#)

Education

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee
PhD in Political Science

Milwaukee, Wisconsin
2022–Present (expected May 2027)

Bilkent University
MA in International Relations

Ankara, Turkey
2020–2022

Bilkent University
BA in International Relations

Ankara, Turkey
2015–2020

Dissertation

When U.S. Coercive Signals Fail: Essays on Coercive Statecraft in International Security
Committee: John Reuter, Shale Horowitz, Natasha Borges Sugiyama

My dissertation explains why coercive threats fail despite substantial material leverage. Using a mixed-method research design, I examine how coercive signals are produced, communicated, and interpreted in adversarial relationships. The project combines survey experiments, quantitative analysis, computational methods, and qualitative evidence.

Research Fields and Methods

Primary Fields: International Relations, Comparative Politics

Research Areas: International Security, Foreign Policy Analysis, Coercive Statecraft, Authoritarian Politics, Technology and International Security

Methods: Survey Experiments, Data Science, Computational Text Analysis, Statistical Analysis, Archival Research, Interviews

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2025. “Hawkish Leaders and Foreign Policy: A Political Psychological Approach.” *International Political Science Review*. [Link](#).
- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2025. “The Transition from Quantitative to Computational Methods in Foreign Policy Analysis.” *International Relations*. [Link](#).
- Doğrul, Mürsel, and Ahmet Ergurum. 2021. “New Search for Cybersecurity in the Light of Blockchain’s Literature Expansion.” *Journal of Security Sciences*. [In Turkish]. [Link](#).

Revise and Resubmit

- Gheorghe, Eliza, Ahmet Ergurum, and Mürsel Doğrul. “Caught in the Crossfire: Dual Coercion and Japan’s Semiconductor Strategy Amid U.S.–China Rivalry.” *Contemporary Security Policy*.

Under Review

- Ergurum, Ahmet, Lawrence Rubin, and Dana Abu-Haltam. “Middle Power AI Policy Amid Superpower Rivalry: The Case of the UAE.” Under review at *Global Studies Quarterly*.
- Ergurum, Ahmet. “Affective Polarization, Foreign Policy, and Audience Costs in International Crises.” Under review at *Foreign Policy Analysis*.
- Ergurum, Ahmet. “The Partisan Meaning of Affective Polarization: Evidence from Defense Spending Attitudes.” Under review at *Political Behavior*.
- Ergurum, Ahmet. “Sovereign Compute without Sovereign Chips: Managed Dependence in Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates.” Under review at *Third World Quarterly*.

Original Data

- **Presidential Military Threats Corpus.** A corpus of 112,521 U.S. presidential statements from 1945–2025 for the study of coercive signaling and foreign-policy rhetoric (ongoing).
- **Coercive Threat Design and Adversary Response Dataset.** An original dataset of 425 identified coercive threats across 57 international crises, 35 countries, and 48 political leaders, covering 1946–1996. The dataset codes the specificity of coercive demands and threatened consequences as well as subsequent adversary responses.

Book Project

- *Middle Power Strategy in the Age of Artificial Intelligence.* Editor. Routledge. Accepted for publication.

Book Chapters

- Ergurum, Ahmet. “Mapping Emerging Technology Discourse in the Eastern Mediterranean: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Speeches.” In *Between Conflict and Cooperation in the Eastern Mediterranean, Volume II: Strategic Spaces and Regional Networks*, Springer, accepted for publication.
- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2025. “Turkish Foreign Policy in a Multipolar World Order.” In *Non-Western Middle Powers in the Multipolar Order*. Routledge. [Link](#).
- Doğrul, Mürsel, Ahmet Ergurum, and Haydar Yalçın. 2024. “Technology Intelligence: Cryptocurrencies and Emerging Technologies.” In *Future-Oriented Technology Assessment: A Manager’s Guide with Case Applications*. Wiley. [Link](#).
- Doğrul, Mürsel, Ahmet Ergurum, and Haydar Yalçın. 2024. “The Landscape Analyses of Semiconductor Research Trends of Middle Powers: Mapping the Collaboration Networks of Japan, South Korea, Türkiye, and Malaysia.” In *Global Transformations and Türkiye*. Turkish Academy of Sciences. [Link](#).

Reference Works / Invited Encyclopedia Entries

- BRICS in the Maghreb. *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of African History*. Oxford University Press, with Dana Abu-Haltam, forthcoming.

Policy Writing

- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2024. “How Do Armed Groups Shape the Sudan Civil War?” *Middle East Foundation*.
- Fidan, Ahmet, Bengisu Açıkgoz, and Ahmet Ergurum. 2019. “The Further Potential of Turkmenistan to Export Natural Gas to China.” *Bilkent Energy Notes*. [Link](#).

Working Papers

- “Coercive Threats, Assurances, and Mediation in International Crises: Experimental Evidence from Russia.” Dissertation chapter.
- “Committed but Not Compelling? National Security Institutions and Sanctions Threats.” Dissertation chapter.
- “Selective Specification: How Leaders Allocate Precision in Coercive Threats.” Dissertation chapter.
- “Crossing Domains: Domain Switching and Adversary Response in International Crises.”
- “Shared Attention, Different Agendas: Conflict Intensity and Official Foreign-Policy Attention.”

- “Partisan Asymmetry and Nuclear Politics in the U.S. Congress: Evidence from Large Language Models.”

Research in Progress

- “Leader Hawkishness and Military Spending: A Panel Data Analysis.”
- “Globalization and Networked Nuclear Proliferation: A Multiplex Network Analysis.” With Eliza Gheorghe, Mürsel Doğrul, and Haydar Yalçın.

Awards and Grants

- 2026. ICPSR Summer Program Scholarship, ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods (Data Science and Text Analysis; Causal Inference II), University of Michigan.
- 2026. Wilder Crane Memorial Scholarship, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2026. Travel Grant, International Studies Association Annual Conference.
- 2025. Research Grant, Institute for Humane Studies, George Mason University.
- 2025. Travel Grant, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2024. Jerome M. Clubb Scholarship, ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan.
- 2024. Chancellor’s Award, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2024. Travel Grant, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2024. Research Fellowship, Middle East Foundation, Turkey.
- 2023. Fee Waiver and Housing Coverage, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science.
- 2023. Travel Grant, Cornell University Reppy Institute for Peace and Conflict Studies.
- 2023. Travel Grant and Chancellor’s Award, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2022. Developing Nations Scholarship, Midwest Political Science Association.
- 2022. Chancellor’s Award, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2020–2022. Full Scholarship/Stipend (MA), Bilkent University.
- 2019–2022. Fellowship, Ankara Center for Thought and Research (ADAM Derneği), Turkey.
- 2019. Scholarship, Sinan-Wren Foundation, International Media Training Programme.
- 2017. Scholarship, TIKA-Tunisia Ministry of Education, Experience Sharing Program, Volunteering, Tunisia.
- 2014. European Union Project Funding, “My Little Homeland” Erasmus+ Project, Poland.

Research Experience

Governance and Responsible AI Lab (GRAIL), Purdue University Remote
 Graduate Affiliate, AI Governance and Regulatory Archive (AGORA) 2026–Present

- Contribute to a collaborative archive of AI-related legislation supporting research on emerging AI policy and regulation.

Center for AI & Digital Policy (CAIDP) Online
 Research Group Member, AI Policy Clinic January–April 2026

- Selected for CAIDP’s interdisciplinary AI Policy Clinic focused on AI policy analysis, research, and evaluation.
- Contributed to the Argentina country report for the AI and Democracy Values Index book.

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee

Political Attitudes Lab, Co-PI

Milwaukee, Wisconsin

2024–2025

- Collected and analyzed survey data for the project “Religiously Unaffiliated Citizens and Democracy in the United States” under the supervision of Kyle McWagner.

Middle East Foundation

Research Fellow

Ankara, Turkey

July–August 2024

- Authored a policy report on armed groups in the Sudan civil war.
- Conducted interviews with Sudanese subject-matter experts and elites.

Grand Strategy of the U.S. and China: A Role Theory Approach

Remote

Research Assistant

October 2023–June 2024

- Coded presidential speech data to analyze U.S.–China foreign policy with a team of PhD researchers.

Bilkent University

Research Assistant

Ankara, Turkey

2021–2022

- Collected and analyzed archival material from nineteenth-century Ottoman chronicles to analyze great-power conflict decision-making.

Bilkent Energy Policy Research Center

Research Intern

Ankara, Turkey

2019

- Conducted statistical analyses on Turkmenistan’s natural gas reserves, fields, pipelines, and contracts.
- Analyzed alternative pipeline routes and regional foreign policy implications.

Methods, Skills, and Languages

R	Data analysis, visualization, statistical modeling, Data Science
Python	Pandas, Matplotlib, Statistical modeling
SQL	Data manipulation, MySQL, IBM Db2
Power BI	Data analysis and visualization
Qualtrics	Survey design
Other	LaTeX, GitHub
Languages	Turkish (native), English (professional proficiency), French (beginner)

Selected Methodological Training

- Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models (EITM) Certification, EITM Institute, 2026.
- Emerging Methodologists Workshop (EMW), IQMR Syracuse University, 2026.
- ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan, 2026 (coursework in data science and text analysis; empirical modeling of social science theory; causal inference; and time-series, panel, and longitudinal data analysis).
- ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan, 2024 (coursework in machine learning and multilevel models).
- Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, 2023.
- Hertie School Data Science Lab, Data Science Summer School, 2021.
- IPSA–ABU Social Science Research Methods Summer School, 2021.

Conference Presentations

- **2026.** “How Middle Powers Navigate Great Power Rivalry? The Case of the UAE’s AI and 5G Policy.” With Lawrence Rubin and Dana Abu-Haltam. *International Studies Association Annual*

Convention, Columbus.

- **2026.** “The Impact of U.S. Administrative Shifts on Middle Eastern Foreign Policy Amid U.S.–China Competition.” *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Columbus.*
- **2026.** “Networked Proliferation: Globalization, International Institutions, and the Spread of Nuclear Weapons.” With Eliza Gheorghe, Mürsel Doğrul, and Haydar Yalçın. *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Columbus.*
- **2026.** “From Smart Power to Spatial Transformation: Rethinking Regionalism in the Trump Era.” Roundtable participant. *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Columbus.*
- **2025.** “David Ben-Gurion and Moshe Sharett as Founders of Israeli Strategic Culture: An Operational Code Approach.” *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Chicago.*
- **2025.** “Polarization and Threat Perceptions: Attitudes Toward Defense Spending in the United States.” *ISA International Security Studies Section–International Security Studies Regional Conference, Washington, DC.*
- **2025.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *ISA International Security Studies Section–International Security Studies Regional Conference, Washington, DC.*
- **2025.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2025.** “Leader Hawkishness and Military Spending: A Panel Data Analysis.” *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Chicago.*
- **2024.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *ISA Northeast Annual Conference, Baltimore.*
- **2024.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *Cornell University Reppy Institute for Peace and Conflict Studies Conference.*
- **2024.** “Leader Hawkishness and Military Spending: A Panel Data Analysis.” *ISA Northeast Annual Conference, Baltimore.*
- **2023.** “Right-Wing Populism and Foreign Policy: An Operational Code Analysis.” *ISA Midwest Conference.*
- **2023.** “Right-Wing Populism and Foreign Policy: An Operational Code Analysis.” *Turkish Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2023.** “Operational Code Analysis of Hawkish Leaders.” *Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2023.** “David Ben-Gurion and Moshe Sharett as Founders of Israeli Strategic Culture: An Operational Code Approach.” *Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2022.** “Do Advancements in the Defense Industry Lead the Same in Blockchain Literature?” With Mürsel Doğrul and Haydar Yalçın. *American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.*

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee
Introduction to International Relations

Milwaukee, Wisconsin
Spring 2027

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee
Comparative Political Systems

Milwaukee, Wisconsin
Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Political Science

Milwaukee, Wisconsin

2022–Present

- Chinese Politics and Foreign Policy
- Nationalism and Ethnic Conflict
- The Politics of International Economic Relations
- Comparative Political Systems
- Introduction to Global Studies I: People and Politics
- Latin American Politics
- Morality, Conflict and War
- History of International Political Thought
- Politics of World's Nations
- Introduction to American Government and Politics
- Introduction to Political Science

Courses Prepared to Teach

Introduction to International Relations; Introduction to Political Science; Introduction to Middle East Politics; International Security; Foreign Policy Analysis; Comparative Politics; Authoritarian Politics; Technology and World Politics; Comparative Political Systems; Public Opinion and Foreign Policy; American Foreign Policy

Professional Service

- Panel Chair and Discussant, International Studies Association Annual Conference, 2026.
- Technical Moderator, ISA 2025 Virtual Conference.
- Report Peer Reviewer and Language Editor, Turkish Academy of Sciences (TUBA), 2025.
- Panel Discussant, International Studies Association Annual Conference, 2025.
- Technical Moderator, ISA 2024 Virtual Conference.
- Conference Organization Committee Member, Turkish Academy of Sciences (TUBA), 2021.

Academic Journal Reviewer

- *Political Research Quarterly*
- *Global Studies Quarterly*
- *International Politics*
- *International Political Science Review*
- *Southeast European and Black Sea Studies*
- *Orbis Journal of World Affairs*

References

Ora John Reuter

Professor of Political Science; Director of Graduate Studies

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee | reutero@uwm.edu

Shale Horowitz

Professor of Political Science; Director, International Studies

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee | shale@uwm.edu

Natasha Borges Sugiyama

Professor of Political Science; Director, Center for Latin American and Caribbean Studies

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee | sugiyamn@uwm.edu